

Diego Leyton

Senior Software Engineer and Creative Technologist

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Senior Software Engineer and Creative Technologist with 14+ years of experience building interactive products across **games, AR/VR, and consumer applications**. I specialize in turning ambitious ideas into polished experiences by combining strong engineering, product thinking, and creativity.

At **Meta**, I served as an **Engineering Manager and Technical Lead** on Horizon Worlds, building large-scale social and multiplayer VR experiences. I am also the **founder of MarMilo**, a Unity-based family application that I have taken from concept to betavalidation with real users.

CAREER SUMMARY

- **14+ years of experience** building interactive products across **games, AR/VR, education, and consumer applications**.
- **7 years at Meta (Facebook)**, serving as **Engineering Manager and Tech Lead** on Horizon Worlds, delivering **large-scale multiplayer VR experiences**.
- Previously **Lead Engineer at Meta Company (AR startup)**, developing **Augmented Reality collaboration technology**, following **5 years in the game industry** (DeNA, Atakama Labs) leading and shipping mobile games worldwide on Google Play, the App Store, and Amazon Appstore.
- **Founder of MarMilo**, leading **product strategy, UX, and engineering** for a family technology platform focused on **positive habits, child independence, and real-world learning**.

IMPACT SUMMARY

Product Development

Built products used by millions of users, including Meta's Horizon Worlds and multiple mobile games.

Engineering Excellence

Led large-scale engineering initiatives at Meta, including architecture and UI migrations, as well as a cross-team quality initiative spanning **9 teams (~90 engineers)** that increased automated test coverage **from 50% to 90%**.

AR Innovation

Invented a patented smartphone-to-AR interaction technique, helping secure investor funding and earning the **AWE 2017 Best Presentation Award**.

Architecture Design

Created the MVCB architecture pattern, adopted across multiple AR projects.

Family & Education

Founded MarMilo, building a family-centered platform that connects positive habits, child autonomy, real-world routines, and interactive learning experiences.

EXPERIENCE

MarMilo

Founder, Product & Engineering

May 2026 — Present

MarMilo · CA, USA

- Founded and built [MarMilo](#), a **cross-platform family technology platform** designed to help children build positive habits, independence, and everyday routines.
- Architected and built the **multi-app ecosystem**, including Parents and Kids experiences, cloud synchronization, interactive UI/UX, and a reusable framework for integrating new learning and routine-based experiences.
- Designed MarMilla, a **human-in-the-loop AI system** that helps parents explore everyday challenges and create practical, adaptable plans while keeping parents in control of every decision.
- Built interactive experiences including **Maths, Brush, and Coding**, connecting digital guidance with learning and activities in the real world.
- Leading **product strategy, UX, architecture, and engineering**, including interaction design and original music and sound, while iterating with families and collaborating with researchers, educators, and clinical professionals.

Meta (Facebook)

Tech Lead / Engineering Manager in [Horizon Worlds](#).

Senior Software Engineer & Tech Lead (Horizon Worlds)

Aug 2023 — Mar 2026

Meta (Facebook) · Menlo Park, CA, USA

- **Led performance tools team**, enabling creators to evaluate and improve runtime performance across Horizon platforms.
- **Led a pillar-wide quality initiative across 9 teams (~90 engineers)**, increasing automated test coverage from 50% to 90% and reducing regressions.
- **Worked directly with Horizon Worlds creators** to understand real workflows, identify pain points, and translate feedback into product, tooling, and UX improvements.

Engineering Manager (Horizon Worlds Creation Tools)

Jan 2021 — Aug 2023

Meta (Facebook) · Menlo Park, CA, USA

- **Managed Horizon Worlds team (10+ engineers)**, providing [Creation Tools](#) to users so they can build and share their immersive experiences.
- **Led the migration of Horizon Worlds CreationTools architecture**, enabling faster iteration and better creator experiences.

Senior Software Engineer / Tech Lead

Dec 2018 — Jan 2021

Meta (Facebook) · Menlo Park, CA, USA

- **Tech Lead for Horizon Worlds Creation Tools**, building core creation workflows for Horizon's first generation of creators.
- **Led development of Horizon Worlds' VR UI framework**, used across product experiences and creation tools.
- Built core systems for the **first version of Horizon Worlds**, from early product development through launch.
- **Created a comprehensive [Creation Tools & Scripting tutorial](#) for the creator community**, later featured as a recommended resource for beginners.

Meta Company (AR)

Lead Engineer (Augmented Reality)

Dec 2016 — Sep 2018

Meta Company (AR) · San Mateo, CA, USA

- **Led Collaboration in Augmented Reality:** With this feature, users can simultaneously interact with holograms in the AR workspace.
- **Created the org widely used architecture pattern MVCB** based on MVC, to work with different game and graphical engines.
- **Meta Cloud Infrastructure (GoLang):** Worked as a backend and frontend software engineer developing the Meta Cloud infrastructure and micro-services.
- **Inventor of the interaction with Smart Phones in Augmented Reality.** This is an intuitive way to grab content from a Smart Phone, just using the hands (patented). Videos: [Collaboration in AR](#) and [Importing 3D Models](#).
- **Winner of the best presentation for Augmented Reality Award** in AWE 2017, the largest AR+VR event in the world.
- **Managed the architecture improvement** of the Meta2 Workspace, a working environment for Augmented Reality.
- Part of the **SDK team**, implementing features as the calibration profile system for the Meta2 headset.

DeNA Studios

Worked developing **video games as a Technical Lead Engineer.**

Technical Lead Engineer

Jun 2015 — Dec 2016

DeNA Studios San Francisco · San Francisco, CA, USA

- **Technical Lead Engineer of [Deck Storm](#) (Unity 3D).** This is a modern mobile game based on customizable collectible card game (CCCG), and released in Google Play and Apple AppStore.
- **Proposed and successfully implemented engineering quality standards**, reducing the amount of issues found by QA, and improving our game quality, robustness and user experience.

Senior Software Engineer

Feb 2014 — Jun 2015

DeNA Studios Canada · Vancouver, BC, Canada

- **Designed the software architecture** used in most company games.
- Worked on [World of Thingies](#) (Unity3D). This mobile video game was released in Google Play, Apple AppStore and Amazon AppStore.

Software Engineer → Lead Engineer → Project Manager

Jun 2011 — Feb 2014

Atakama Labs (DeNA Studios Santiago) · Santiago, Chile

- **Led [Dungeons and Dragons Arena of War](#) (Unity 3D) and [Galaxy Assault](#) (JavaScript),** games released on Google Play and App Store.
- **Evangelized Unity 3D** adoption across teams through mentorship and training.
- Collaborated with DeNA San Francisco to enhance the company's internal framework (C++, Objective-C, Java, JS).
- Contributed to the Android port of [Zombie Farm](#) using the internal engine; **this title was a key factor in DeNA's acquisition of the company.**

SKILLS

Tech

- C#
- Unity 3D
- C++
- Java
- JavaScript
- React

Methods & Leadership

- Team Management
- Front End
- Agile Methodologies

Domains

- Augmented Reality
- Virtual Reality
- Game Development
- Educational Technologies

Quality & Tools

- Software Usability
- Git
- Phabricator

EDUCATION

Master's Degree, Computer Science University of Chile	2010 — 2013
Engineers' Degree, Computer Science University of Chile	2008 — 2013
Bachelor's Degree, Computer Science University of Chile	2005 — 2008
Outstanding Student, Computer Science University of Chile	2009 — 2009

PUBLICATIONS

- Leyton, D.; Pino, J.A.; Ochoa, S.F., "EBTAM: technology acceptance in e-Business environments", Information Systems and e-Business Management, 01 May. 2015.
DOI: 10.1007/s10257-014-0255-2
- Leyton, D.; Pino, J.A.; Ochoa, S.F., "Modeling Technology Acceptance in E-Business Environments", e-Business Engineering (ICEBE), 2013 IEEE 10th International Conference on Coventry, UK, pp.90, 97, 11-13 Sept. 2013.
DOI: 10.1109/ICEBE.2013.14

LANGUAGES

- English — Fluent (written and spoken)
- Spanish — Native